

Why Your About Page Is the Most Underrated Page for AI Citations

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Most businesses treat the About page as an afterthought. AI engines treat it as the primary source of truth about who you are. That mismatch is costing you citations.

The page you ignore is the page the machines read first

Ask most operators to name their most important page and they will say the homepage, or a high-converting service page. Ask an AI engine, and the answer is often the About page. When ChatGPT, Perplexity, or Gemini needs to establish who you are — to decide whether you are a real, credible entity worth recommending — the About page is where it goes looking. It is the single densest source of identity signals on most websites, and it is almost always neglected.

This is a structural mismatch. The page you treat as a formality is the page that determines whether the machines can confidently answer "who is this business?" And confidence is the currency of AI recommendation.

Entities, not keywords

To understand why the About page carries so much weight, you have to understand how modern AI engines think. They do not primarily match keywords; they resolve entities. An entity is a distinct, identifiable thing — a person, a company, a place — that the engine can connect to a web of facts: what it does, when it was founded, where it operates, who runs it, what it is known for.

When an engine cannot confidently resolve your business as an entity, it does one of two things. It hedges ("I don't have specific information about this company"), or it recommends a competitor it can resolve with confidence. Your About page is the clearest opportunity you have to make yourself unambiguously resolvable.

What an AI-ready About page must contain

The engines are looking for a specific set of identity facts. A strong About page states them plainly rather than burying them in narrative.

Founder and leadership identity

Name the people who run the business. Include a real founder bio with credentials, background, and relevant expertise. AI engines increasingly weight the identity and authority of the humans behind a business — a legacy of the experience-and-expertise standards that shaped search for years, now applied to entity resolution. "Founded by Jane Okafor, a licensed structural engineer with 18 years in commercial retrofits" is a citable fact. "Our team is passionate about quality" is not.

Founding date and history

State when the business was founded and, briefly, how it came to be. Longevity is a trust signal, and a specific founding year is an anchoring fact engines extract and repeat.

Location and service area

Name your physical location and the geography you serve. This is essential for the local and regional queries that dominate commercial AI search.

Mission and specialty

Say clearly what you do and, more importantly, what you are specifically known for. Specificity beats breadth. "We help independent restaurants recover margin through menu engineering" is more resolvable than "we offer business consulting."

Proof of expertise

Credentials, notable clients, years in operation, recognitions, measurable outcomes. These are the facts that move you from "exists" to "credible."

Structure it for machines, not just readers

Content is necessary but not sufficient. How you structure the page determines how reliably an engine can extract it.

Use plain, declarative statements

Write facts as clean sentences a machine can lift verbatim. Front-load the important claim. Avoid cleverness that obscures the fact.

Add Organization and Person schema

Mark up the page with structured data — Organization schema for the business, Person schema for founders and key leaders. Populate the fields that carry identity: name, foundingDate, founder, address, description, and the sameAs links that connect your entity to its other authoritative profiles (LinkedIn, industry directories, Wikipedia if applicable). Schema is the difference between hoping the engine infers a fact and telling it the fact directly.

Use clear headings and logical order

Headings that name what follows — who we are, what we do, who we serve, our credentials — help engines segment and extract the page. A well-structured About page is easier to cite than a beautiful but ambiguous one.

What engines actually extract

When we audit client About pages against live AI results, the pattern is consistent. Engines pull the founding year, the founder's name and credential, the specific specialty, and the service geography — then use those facts to frame every subsequent mention of the business. Get those four facts stated clearly and marked up, and you see the engine repeat them accurately. Leave them vague, and you see the engine either omit you or invent plausible-but-wrong details, which is worse.

We have watched businesses go from "I don't have information about this company" to being described with an accurate founder bio and specialty inside a single re-indexing cycle — the only change being a rewritten, structured About page.

The compounding effect

A strong About page does not just help the About page rank. It stabilizes your entire entity. Every other page, every citation, every mention becomes easier for engines to connect back to a confident, well-defined identity. It is foundational infrastructure — which is exactly why it deserves more attention than the marketing copy that usually gets all of it. Fix the foundation, and everything built on top of it holds.

The About page is not a formality. It is the primary source AI engines use to decide who you are and whether you are worth recommending. State your founder, founding date, location, specialty, and proof of expertise plainly, mark them up with schema, and structure the page so a machine can extract it cleanly. Do that, and you give every engine the confident, accurate entity it needs before it will ever put your name in an answer.

Frequently Asked Questions

Why do AI engines rely on the About page specifically?

Because it is typically the densest source of identity facts on a website — founder, founding date, location, mission, and expertise in one place. AI engines resolve businesses as entities before recommending them, and the About page is where they most reliably find the facts needed to do that resolution with confidence.

What is the single most important thing to add to my About page?

A specific, credentialed founder or leadership bio, paired with a clear statement of what you are specifically known for. AI engines weight the authority of the humans behind a business heavily, and specificity of expertise is what moves you from a business that merely exists to one the engine treats as credible.

Do I really need schema markup on my About page?

It is strongly recommended. Organization and Person schema let you state identity facts directly rather than hoping the engine infers them from prose. Populating fields like foundingDate, founder, address, and sameAs links removes ambiguity and materially improves how accurately engines describe you.

What are sameAs links and why do they matter?

sameAs is a schema property that connects your entity to its other authoritative profiles — LinkedIn, industry directories, and similar. These links help engines confirm they have resolved the correct entity by cross-referencing consistent facts across multiple trusted sources, which increases their confidence in recommending you.

Can a bad About page actually hurt me?

Yes. A vague or inaccurate About page can lead engines to omit you entirely, confuse you with another business, or invent plausible-but-wrong details. Fabricated or incorrect information is often worse than absence, because it erodes buyer trust at the exact moment of consideration.

How long does it take for changes to show up in AI results?

It varies by engine, but structured, well-written About page changes often register within a single re-indexing cycle — sometimes days to a few weeks. Because the fix is foundational to your entire entity, its effects also compound across every other page and citation over the following weeks.